

Heart Health: General Information

Keeping the heart healthy

Heart disease is a leading cause of death worldwide. Many risk factors can be improved: high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, smoking, excess weight, physical inactivity and an unhealthy diet.

Physical activity

Adults are generally advised to aim for at least 150 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity per week, such as brisk walking or cycling, plus muscle-strengthening activity on two or more days. People with existing conditions should check with a healthcare professional before starting a new routine.

Heart-healthy eating

A heart-healthy eating pattern emphasises vegetables, fruits, whole grains, legumes, nuts, fish and unsaturated oils, while limiting processed foods, added sugars, saturated fat and salt.

Warning signs of a heart attack

Warning signs can include chest pain or pressure, pain spreading to the arm, jaw, neck or back, shortness of breath, cold sweat, nausea and light-headedness. Symptoms can differ between people. These signs need emergency medical help right away; do not wait to see if they pass.